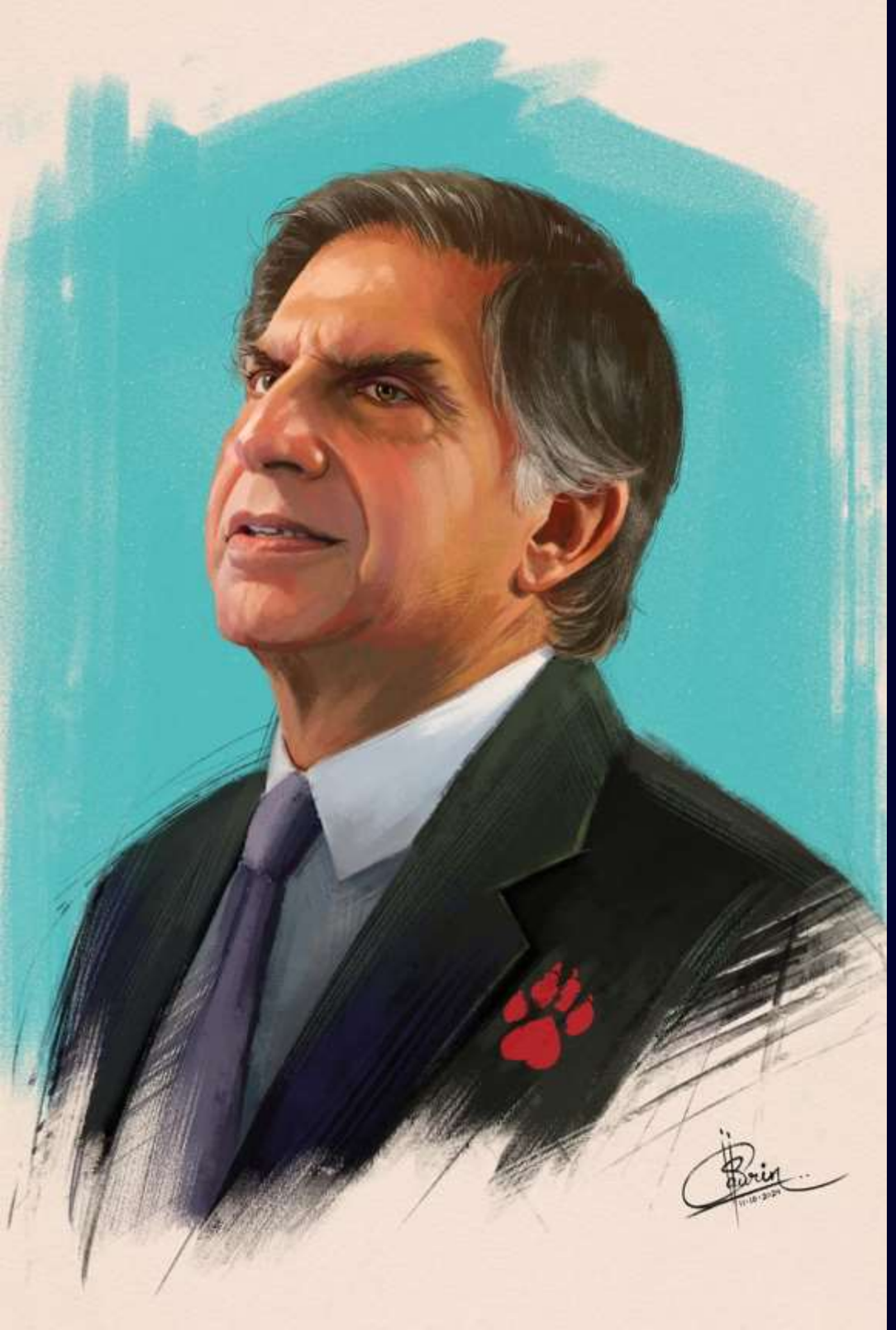

Ratan Tata — Leadership • Ethics • Global Vision

Corporate Governance & Business Legacy

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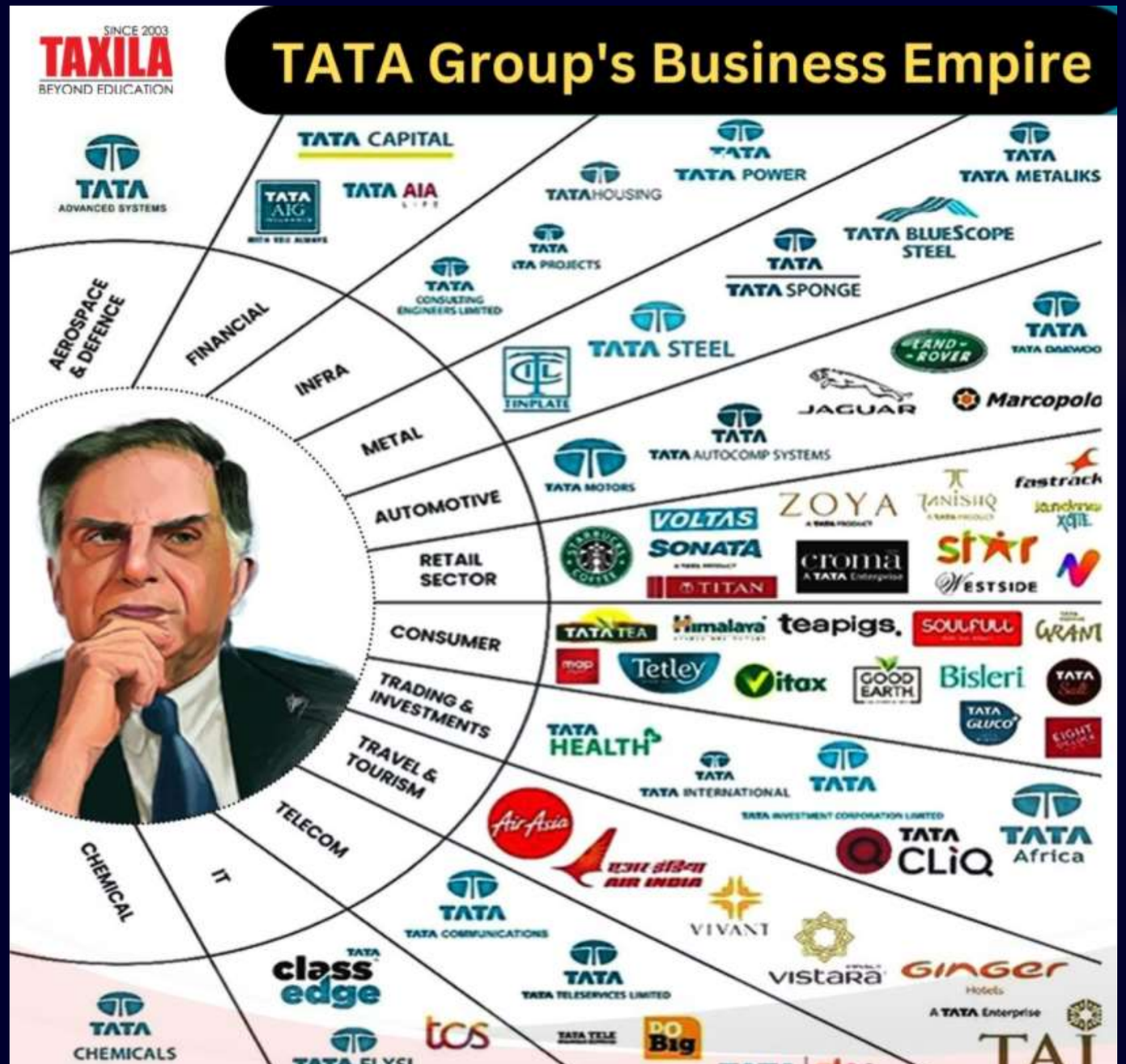
Tata Group: A Global Conglomerate



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Early Life & Formative Years

Born 1937, Mumbai

Raised by grandmother

Cornell University graduate

Joined Tata Steel shop floor

Concise milestones that shaped a hands-on, disciplined leader.

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Personal Life & Close Circle

Never married

Chooses simplicity and focus on public service.

Philanthropy

Significant personal and institutional giving through Tata Trusts.

Close associate

Shantanu Naidu — early entrepreneur who later collaborated with Tata initiatives.

Personal simplicity reinforced a public-facing ethos of service and restraint.

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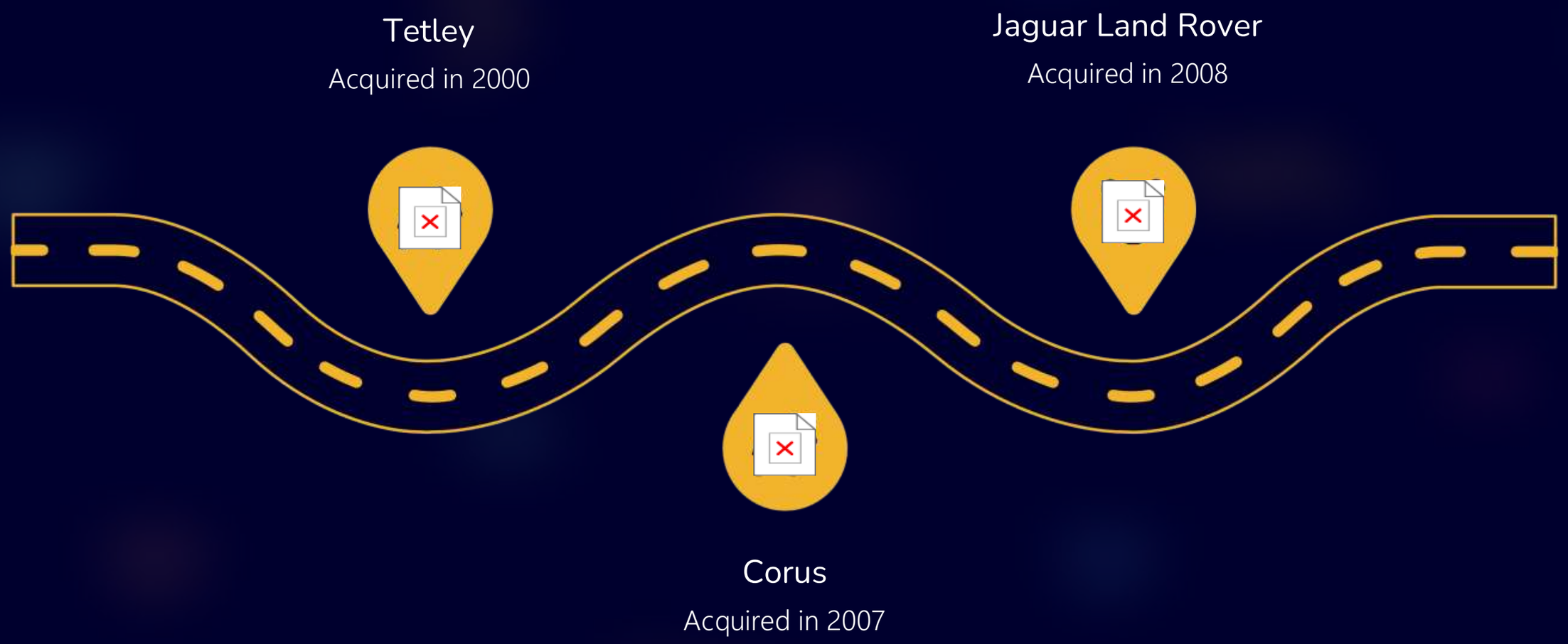
Global Expansion: Strategic Acquisitions



Ambitious, acquisitive phase that transformed Tata from a national industrial group into a recognised global brand.

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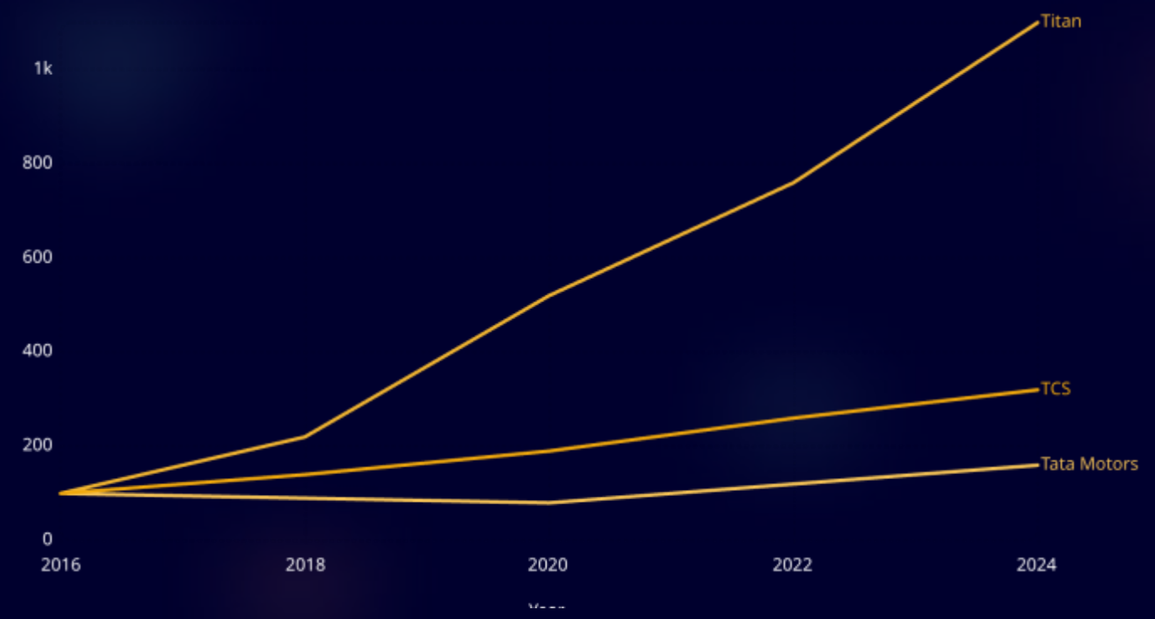
Shares & Long-Term Stock Performance



Comparison: TCS shows steady, compound growth; Titan emerged as a multibagger; Tata Motors drifted with cyclical volatility tied to auto cycles and strategic restructuring.

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Business Scale — Snapshot Numbers

165B

Group Revenue

Approximate consolidated turnover (USD).

1M+

Employees

Over one million people across businesses and geographies.

100+

Countries

Global presence spanning continents and markets.

30+

Listed Companies

More than thirty publicly listed Tata companies.

Scale, diversity, and sustained employment are core features of the Tata Group's social and economic footprint.

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Goodfellows — Shantanu Naidu Startup (Senior Companion Service)

Goodfellows

Companion service matching trained young visitors with elderly people to reduce social isolation. Supported by Ratan Tata through mentorship and seed backing.

Register

Older adults or families sign up and specify preferences.

Match

Carefully screened volunteers matched for compatibility.

Weekly Visits

Regular companionship sessions to build trust and routine.

Practical social impact combining entrepreneurship with Tata's philanthropic values.

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Corporate Case Study: Ratan Tata vs Cyrus Mistry

- Leadership dispute at Tata Sons following governance and strategic differences.
- High-profile corporate governance case that captured regulatory and public attention.
- The Supreme Court ultimately upheld the Tata board's position, reinforcing board authority.

Significant precedent for Indian corporate governance, board accountability, and succession clarity.

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Key Takeaways & Signature Quote

Ethical Leadership

Decisions anchored in stakeholder value, long-term trust, and institutional reputation.

Long-Term Thinking

Strategic patience — building global scale through selective, bold acquisitions.

Philanthropy-Driven Capitalism

Integration of commercial success with social impact via Tata Trusts.

Global Brand Builder

Elevated Indian industry onto the world stage while maintaining national roots.

> “I don’t believe in taking right decisions. I take decisions and make them right.”

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